



Kern It!

You think you know kerning? You don't know! Nothin' 'til you play this, boy! Wha'chu waiting for?
<http://dgit.in/kernit>



After the Disco

A sci-fi web series starring Anton Yelchin and Kate Mara. Take a look:
<http://dgit.in/brokenbatd>



This month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

Readers' write-ups



Praneet Sab

PHP: 5 reasons to code in it.

What does PHP have that makes everyone love it? The answer is simple. It offers you an all inclusive canvas to let you bring out

the best of your skills in server side scripting. PHP is really easy to write, easy to learn, and it's easy to begin coding with. There may be many people who don't know coding but just to give you a hint, first start off with HTML, next with CSS and then directly get into PHP with MySQL and finally dazzle the internet with your skills.

If you want your site to be dynamic, object oriented, need a user system and more; then PHP is your answer. There are more than 244M sites using PHP which includes Facebook, Wikipedia, Twitter and many others that you visit frequently. If you're finding reasons to code in PHP then read the following.

1) Ease of access:

PHP is built in such a way that it's easy to learn and use for beginners while being complex enough for professionals as well. There are simple functions and a few of them have the potential to perform many things. For testing purposes, installing xampp for windows on your own PC would solve your server problems. To learn PHP you don't need to buy books, as there are already thousands of free videos tutorials and websites which are enough to turn you into a professional coder.

2) Feature-rich:

PHP can do calculations, it can generate graphics, send e-mails, can be used in making a blog or forum, allow login/user system. The possibilities are unending

and it just depends on how you use PHP and what you make out of those functions.

3) Widespread & Availability:

There are many hosting servers that provide hosting with PHP for free, whereas hosting with other languages such as C++ is not easily available on free servers. Most of the coders use PHP and thus most scripts sold online are in PHP only. This makes easy integration of other's PHP scripts with your own site. Moreover, if you face a problem with your PHP code, then you can post your query on forums to get it sorted out by professionals.

4) Integration:

PHP allows you to write HTML, CSS, MySQL codes in one PHP file; in fact you can use HTML tags within the PHP braces, thus it makes all the code go into one file.

5) Earn money:

You can earn money using most languages and PHP is no different. Write a code about anything and put it up for sale online. If it's really good then you're good to go. You can put up a portfolio of yourself on freelancer sites and people would hire you to code their sites.



Kedar Deore

Introduction to Information Security

Or `Cybersecurity` for those of you who prefer meaningless buzzwords. Any term with cyber suf-

fixed to it is done for because of two reasons. One is marketing and the other is when you don't know of a more appropriate term to use. Please, stop using and promoting the use of `cyber`. It used to

be relevant once, but not anymore /rant over. One fairly relevant word that you will come across is 'hacker'. The term 'hacker' is most often associated with wrongdoings related to computers. A hacker is an expert, and expertise can be applied both ways. The hacker mindset involves subverting restrictions, making devices and appliances do things they aren't supposed to, making modifications that increase performance and efficiency, automating mundane tasks in fascinating ways. Doing things because they "can" be done. Hacks can be done for fun, or profit (or both). If you think of ways in which you can take stuff past that police checkpoint with your car, not because your intent is malicious, but because it can be done and this signifies a weakness in security control. Not every InfoSec professional is a hacker, but it's what separates the better ones from the rest. InfoSec is a huge field consisting of various sub-fields, from cryptography to reverse engineering. I will discuss some here.

Cryptography is for math lovers out there. And I don't mean those whose knowledge ends at Caesar and Vigenère ciphers. It's an extremely specialized field requiring degree-level knowledge in math to know the ins and outs of crypto protocols. If Prime numbers, Euler's totient function, Euclidean algorithm, Diffie-Hellman, Bob and Alice sound familiar, you may already be into cryptography. When I mention these requirements, I mean to stress on the amount of knowledge required to write a protocol, audit and find weaknesses in one. Depending on your level of interest and expertise you may find weaknesses in the application of RC4 / XOR (hint Whatsapp) or fake DKIM signature in email headers to spoof email from one Google co-founder to the other.